Use ChatGPT to Get Your Family's Planning Questions in Order

Four prompts to bring the pieces into one picture, separate now from later, name the events that would make you pick this up again, and match each open question to the right professional.

Where you are

Mom is managing for now. You've noticed a few changes, there's a folder of statements somewhere, a will signed years ago, and something you once read about Medicaid. Different people have told you different things, and none of it is in one place.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names and account numbers removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not know your state's Medicaid rules, determine eligibility, or give legal, tax, or financial advice. Rules vary by state. Bring those questions to your Medicaid planner, an elder law attorney, or a licensed financial professional.

What you'll have at the end

You can say where things stand today, what your family is keeping an eye on, what would make you pick this up again, and which professional each open question belongs to.

A one-page Where We Stand sheet: Where things stand today, What we're watching, What would make us pick this up again, and Questions and who to ask.

Before you start

- Your notes on Mom's care needs and what she has said she wants, however rough.
- Her finances in round numbers, and the legal documents you know exist.
- Anything you've been told about Medicaid so far, and who said it. One of these is enough to start.

PROMPT 1

Bring the pieces into one picture

WHY THIS MATTERS

Planning ahead usually starts in pieces: something you noticed about Mom's health, a folder of statements, a will signed years ago, a thing you read about Medicaid. Seeing the pieces together shows which ones nobody has looked at.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your notes on Mom's care needs and wishes, her finances in round numbers, anything you've learned about Medicaid, and the legal documents you know exist.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> We are planning ahead for my mother. Nothing needs to be decided today. Here are my notes on her care needs, what she has said she wants, her finances in round numbers, what we've learned about Medicaid so far, and the legal documents we know she has:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Using only what I've written, organize it under five headings: CARE NEEDS, HER PREFERENCES, FINANCES, MEDICAID, and LEGAL DOCUMENTS. Under each heading make three short lists: WHAT WE KNOW, WHAT WE'RE ASSUMING, and WHAT WE HAVEN'T LOOKED AT. Do not add Medicaid rules, numbers, or time frames of your own, and do not say whether she would qualify for anything.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

The headings with the most under WHAT WE HAVEN'T LOOKED AT.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Choose one heading to fill in this month. There's time to take them one at a time.

PROMPT 2

Separate now from later

WHY THIS MATTERS

When a family has time, it's tempting to start doing things: move an account, change a deed, buy a policy. Some steps are simple organizing. Others should wait until a professional has looked, and some only need watching.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The list of things your family thinks it should do, however long.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is the list of things our family thinks we should do to prepare for my mother's possible long-term care:
>
> [PASTE YOUR LIST]
>
> Sort each item into one of three groups: ORGANIZING WE CAN DO NOW (gathering, listing, talking, writing things down), ASK A PROFESSIONAL BEFORE DOING ANYTHING, and KEEP AN EYE ON IT. Put anything that involves moving, gifting, or retitling money or property, creating or changing legal documents, or buying or cancelling insurance in the second group, and say which kind of

> professional to ask: a Medicaid planner, an elder law attorney, or a licensed financial or insurance professional. Do not recommend any strategy, and do not tell me which items matter most.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Items you were ready to act on that belong in the second group.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Do one thing from the first group this week. Leave the second group for the professional named beside each item.

PROMPT 3

Name the events that would make you pick this up again

WHY THIS MATTERS

A plan made ahead of time spends most of its life waiting. What makes it useful is knowing in advance which changes mean it's time to open it again.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your own sense of what would change things for your family.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> We are planning ahead for my mother, and I want to write down the events that would mean it's time to revisit our plan. Here is what our family has said would change things:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Turn my notes into a short list titled WHAT WOULD MAKE US PICK THIS UP AGAIN. Then tell me which of these kinds of change my notes don't mention: a hospital stay, a new diagnosis, changes in memory, needing more help with daily activities, a family caregiver needing more support, a move to a care facility, or care costs rising quickly. List those separately as questions for our family to talk over; do not add them to the list yourself. Do not predict which of these will happen or when, and do not say what we should do when one does.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A list short enough that everyone in the family could remember it.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Share the list with the family members who would be the first to notice a change.

PROMPT 4

Match each open question to the right professional

WHY THIS MATTERS

Planning ahead doesn't mean answering every question yourself. It means knowing which questions exist and who they belong to, so a first meeting with a professional starts further along.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Everything from the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I've organized about planning ahead for my mother:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Give me one page with four headings: WHERE THINGS STAND TODAY, WHAT WE'RE WATCHING, WHAT WOULD MAKE US PICK THIS UP AGAIN, and QUESTIONS AND WHO TO ASK. Under the last heading, mark each question with who should answer it: family, a Medicaid planner, an elder law attorney, a licensed financial or insurance professional, a tax professional, or not sure. Do not answer the questions, and do not turn the page into a plan or a schedule.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A page that would still make sense to you a year from now.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Put today's date on it and keep it. It's the start of the next step below.

Ready for the next step?

You've put your family's questions in order. The planning interview is the next step: it produces a free planning report you can keep with your Where We Stand sheet and bring to your Medicaid planner when you're ready.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›